

NATE BOURGET

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THE LIMIT

Interactive • Research • Publication • Web

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THE LIMIT is a multidisciplinary degree project exploring the contemporary indie underground art scene surrounding 3D software, game engines, and digital image making.

Centered around artists using tools like Blender and game development software to produce experimental animations, games, and visual worlds, the project documents an emerging creative movement through twenty interviews conducted with major creators in the scene, roughly 100 pages of original writing, and two original and entirely unique interactive experiences.

https://natebourget.com/the_limit/

Sato worked as project lead and sole creative visionary on the program, however all of the scenarios for the game were taken, with permission from **Nishikawa**, from her dream journal. The program was released for the Sony Playstation in October 1998, and was nothing less than a full body surreal experience. The game had the player explore environments envisioned by the dream journal, dreamt up by **Hiroko**. Endless, wild environments, not one of them alike. And at the end of the short explorations, your character would wake up and track the progress in their in-game dream journal. Sometimes you would dive deep into the same environment twice and the second time the textures would change into typography, faces of pornstars, or horrific grimaces and warping pixels. This only added to the mystery and draw of the experience. The game is the prototypical surface dweller's idea of "weeeirrrrrrrd trippy art maaan". Nothing in the game makes much sense, it does look very strange, it is completely psychedelic in nature, and there is no apparent point to the experience. But that *is* the point, to experience. Created by two talented visual artists on very limited hardware to drill into your mind and make you *FEEL* something. What came from their collaboration is to most people, a nightmare. But for the open minded few, *LSD: Dream Emulator* became a first real glimpse into making a digital experience with a heavy magnitude in emotional draw. The program gained a massive cult following, the likes of which hasn't been replicated by any other underground digital experience. Remaining CD copies of the game are resold in the 600 to 700 American USD range on Ebay. Sealed copies are well into the high four-figures.

Many talented programmers and artists nowadays do their absolute best to restore *LSD: Dream Emulator* to a playable version on modern hardware. This invites a new dialogue about unlimited-limited production. In this process of digital experience restoration, does the program lose some of the charm that came from it's limitations in the first place? Or are the modern contemporary artists

so incredible at recognizing what makes these experiences special that their restoration only improves the quality of life (controls, frames-per-second, save files) that was missing and called for when the experience first came out? My opinion is that the contemporary artists of the 3D limited digital scene are cult specialists.

"Giant Head" in Kyoto with sexual textures



Although his work spans many mediums and concepts, we are going to focus on his interactive 3D experience titled *KNOWMAD*, released in the year 2000. **Chin** describes the piece as a video game with an installation of a tent and rugs. The game is based around this MAP concept, meaning that "The *KNOWMAD* Confederacy is united by the spirit of MOTION that drives the creative impulse into ACTION and sets the conditions for PLACE." Motion + Action + Place = MAP. The landscape of the video game is mapped from real world nomadic tribal groups throughout the world, eradicated for different reasons. The rugs serve as cultural icons for respective tribes as they weave a psychedelic landscape in the virtual space.

Literally every texture in the game, every inch, every pixel comes from a UV Map, meaning projected image, of a tribal rug. Every wall, every mountain, every animal is made up of the digital cotton rug textures, each completely patterned and winding. *KNOWMAD* exists to pay homage to the tribal cultures it pulls from as well as the virtual space of computer art. *KNOWMAD* promotes the transition of consciousness from the virtual world experience back into real life. The game is built within a classic arcade video cabinet, but then a tent was built around it.

"The worlds within the *KNOWMAD* tents are created in reverence for the beauty of human expression as found in the cultural content of tribal rugs." The nomadic life of tribes has a history of danger, shepherding animals, and civil strife, however nomadic tribe existence bestows the gift of knowledge onto those they come in contact with."

In a way, the same way that **Steyerl** describes low quality images having the benefit of information/knowledge speed and efficiency, the same can be said about spoken stories. Nomadic tribes bestow these gifts upon other travelers, loved ones and family. They leave out pieces that they want to leave out, and the rest is filled in with the recipient's mind. Knowledge transfer is a central concept of missing information especially in the face of a limited circumstance.

An interview with...

Ch4ch

NATE BOURGET I'm wondering if you would be open to doing a short interview about your work and yourself over text?

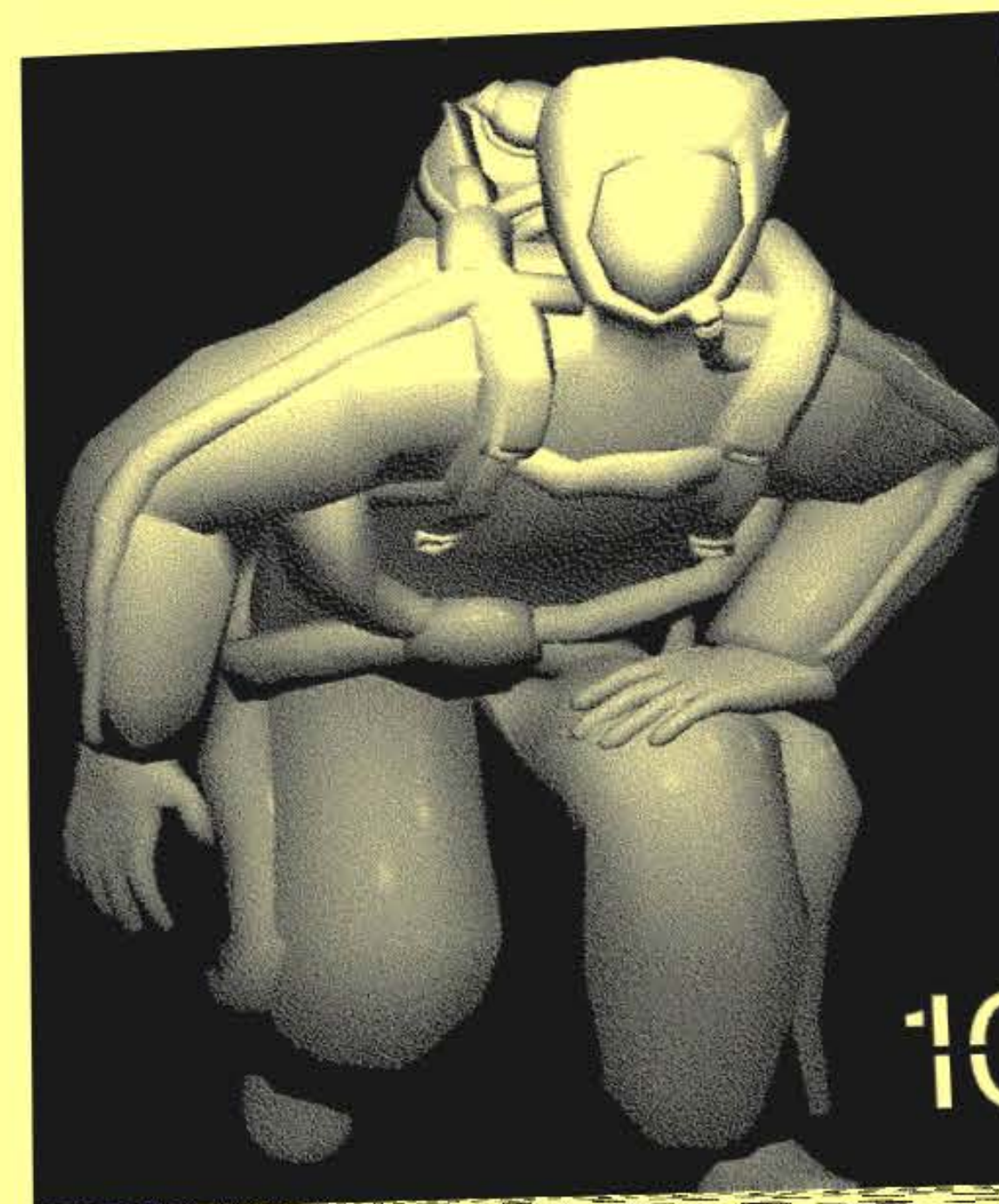
AARON PATRICK Hey :) would love to help, yes, let's do it.



An interview with Aaron Patrick

NB What drew you into working with constrained visuals? Meaning the low poly models, and compressed/flattened textures. If it's an intangible feeling or hard to put your finger on, who are your greatest inspirations?

AP I make that kinda stuff because I enjoy seeing it. I spent all my time playing video games growing up, and it was all these low poly graphics that looked insanely hi-tech at the time. *Custom Robo*, *Twilight Princess*, early *Resident Evils*, etc. In fact, those games are all still insanely polished and ahead of their time compared to most of the low-poly stuff people make on Instagram. But yeah, I'm just obsessed with the process. lykyk, **limitations create more opportunities for creation than if you make stuff with every tool available on hand.**



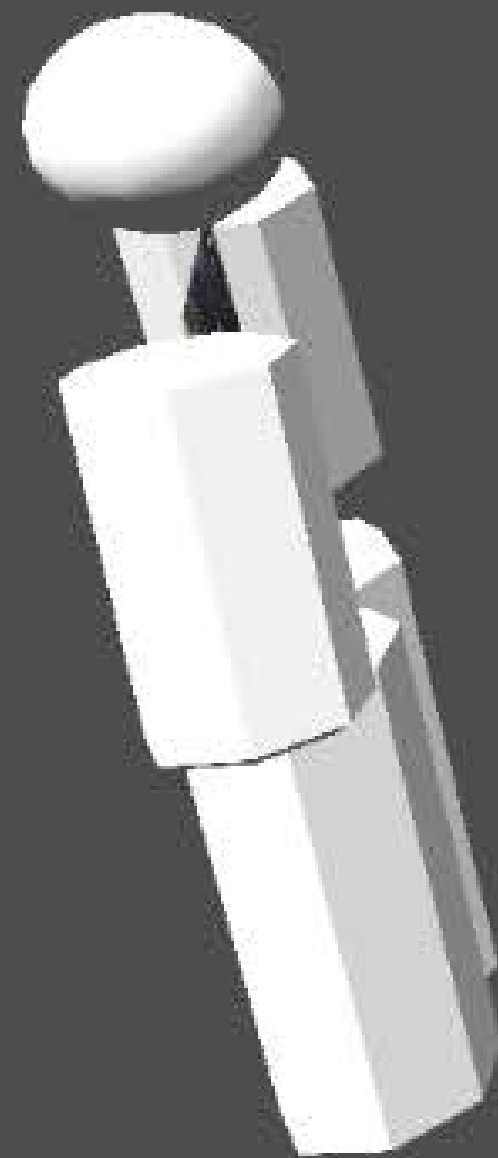
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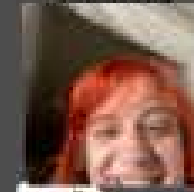




anderdingus



wanda



mike!!



IZ

tsenlives4evr
Enema



nate2



THE GPC

(GARMENT PRINTING CLUB)

Leadership • Prepress • Instruction

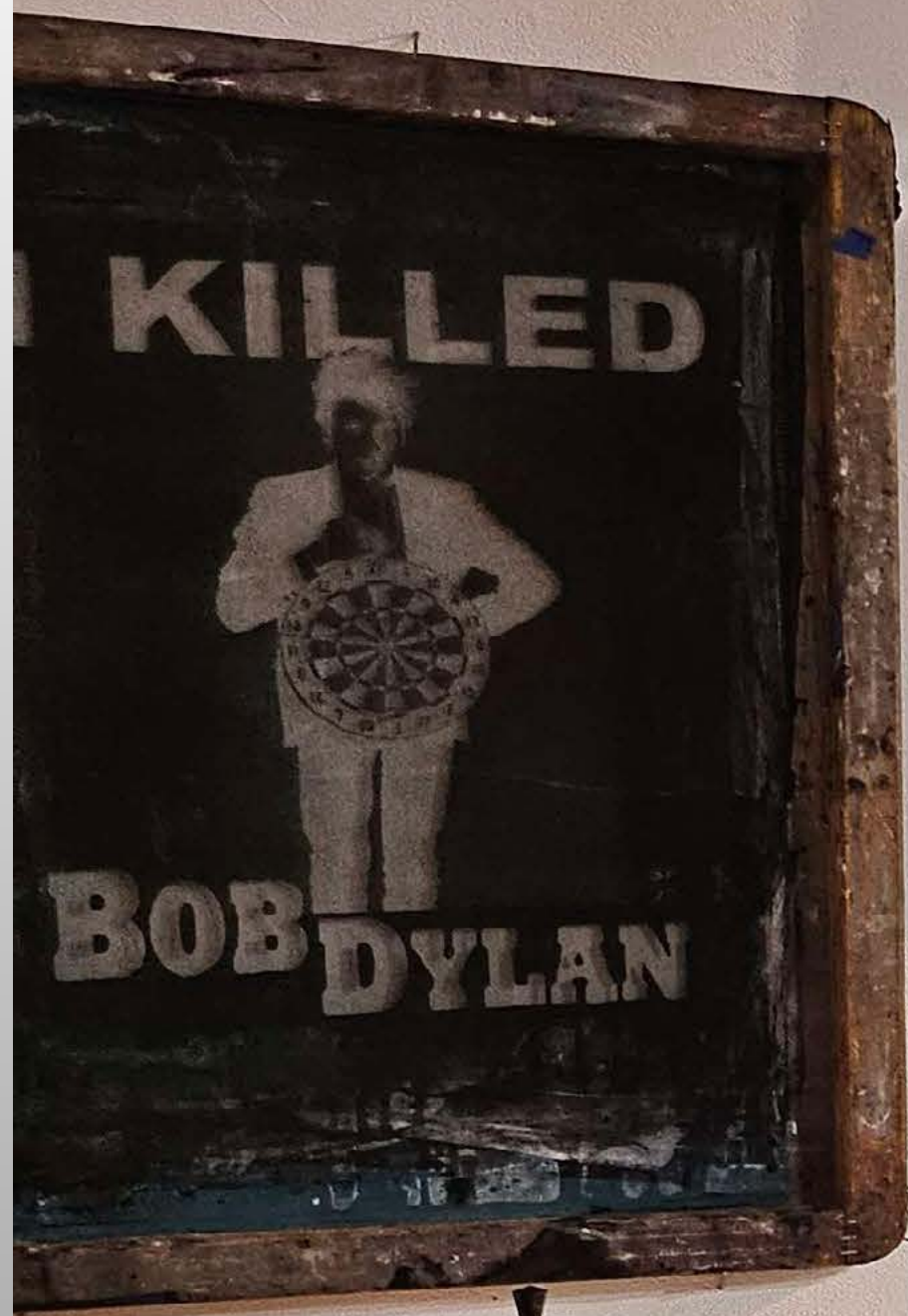
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The Garment Printing Club (GPC) is an organization that I began during my first year at MassArt. I found the exclusive atmosphere of the printmaking studios to be antithetical to the artistic flow at MassArt, which made me want to develop a space for silkscreen printers and begin teaching classes.

The GPC became the most attended student ran organization on campus and earned Student Organization of the Year in 2024. The club supported first-time printers, experienced members, and three large exhibitions.

<https://natebourget.com/gpc/>











KURU

Branding • Typography • Craft

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KURU Fine Dining is an identity project exploring branding, materiality, and narrative through the lens of excess and overconsumption.

The project combines print, typography, and physical materials to create a warm, controlled, and unsettling atmosphere. Menus incorporate perforated elements inspired by butcher cuts, while a mirror polished steel menu board reflects the viewer back into the experience.

Brand guidelines and menu available:

<https://natebourget.com/kuru/>





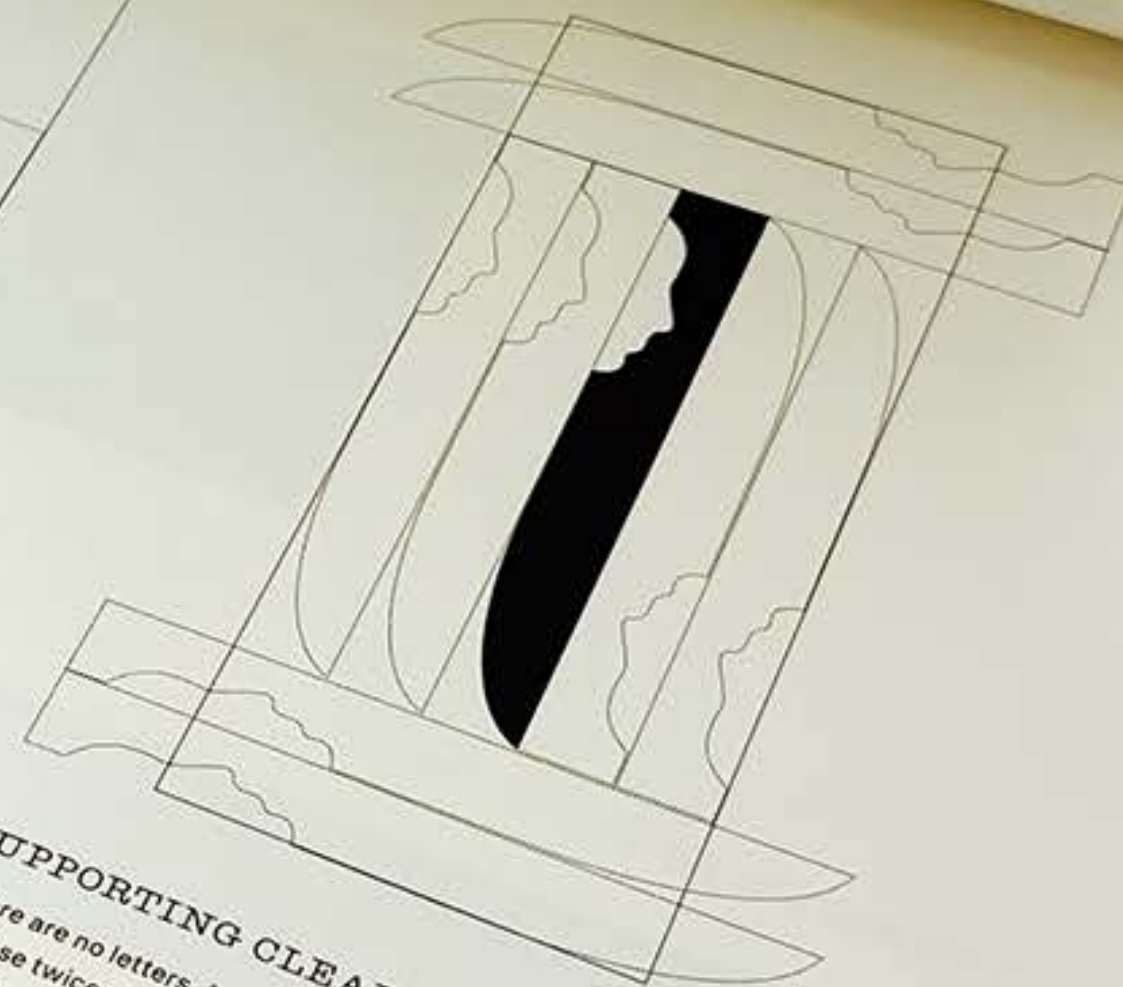
MAIN CLEARSPACE

Always use the width of any of the four letters in the logomark in all four directions.

Brandmark

Clearspace is a matter of legibility, and of respect. The mark operates as a ceremonial object that requires space to exist undisturbed. Surrounding elements are held at a distance to preserve its presence, allowing

the identity to feel deliberate, controlled, and reverent. The same way that a table is set with intention before a private dining ritual, the logo is given room to breathe, and its authority is never diluted.



SUPPORTING CLEARSPACE

If there are no letters, for example the knife icon, use twice the width of the entire mark in all 4 directions.



FFI.5

KURU

IVCJD.002



VCJD.008



FSE.02

SUPPORTING GLYPH
For the cocktail/wine and dessert indulgence menu, use this logomark at the top to signify a change in visual tone

SUPPORTING BRANDMARK
The only supporting mark used by the Kuru brand is the knife logo and the divorced typographic half of the main brandmark or otherwise varied sizes of the knife and type together.

Brandmark

Supporting brandmarks are used in more constrained or repeatable applications where the primary mark would become overwhelming or illegible. These include smaller placements such as print collateral,

digital interfaces, menu footers, and secondary touchpoints. By isolating elements of the primary mark, the identity remains recognizable while adapting to tighter formats.

Main menu and cheque detail



... p.19

Initiate

GRANDE CARPACCIO & CAVIAR 118
Two hand-cut orange rounds layered with beluga caviar and young
asparagus, spiced with aged balsamic and cracked pink pepper.

MARROW CROQUETTES 122
Crisp golden croquettes filled with roasted bone marrow and
herbs, served warm with a rich bechamel and a toasted crumb.

FISH TARTARE 131
Hand-cut tropic ahi tuna folded with avocado, lime, and herbs,
crowned with a raw quail egg and delicate sheets of gold leaf.

CHARRED CEPHALOPOD 131
Tender octopus charred over an open flame, fully dressed with
black garlic oil, preserved lemon, and a young bouquet garni.

The Slab

ANNA CROWLEY 111
Prime cut, seared over high flame and finished with molten foie
gras and saffron butter, served with charred citrus and smoked salt.

MATTHEW WAVERLY 864,908
Cold preparation dressed with bright lemongrass oil and lime,
crowned with a delicately pierced veil of caviar and shaved fennel.

KAYLEIGH PRICE 912,842
Lightly roasted reserve balanced with yuzu oil and fennel pollen,
finished with orchid petals and a forensic trace of citrus ash.

AMBER CRYSTAL BISHOP 574,982
Slow caramelized and wrapped around sweetbreads, lacquered
in a deep pork blood reduction and finished with cracked spice.

DOMINIC HALE 741,890
Prime selection roasted over open flame and rested in brown
butter, finished with charred citrus and cracked spice.

781,854

Item 1: _____
Item 2: _____
Item 3: _____
Item 4: _____
GRAND TOTAL --- PRESENT TO SERVER



Intoxicate

ICEBOX

Gin, blood orange, and spiced honey shaken cold, finished with smoked rosemary and a black salt rim. 101

CORPSE REVIVER No.3

Gin, Lillet Blanc, and orange liqueur shaken with lemon, rinsed with absinthe and served ice cold. 104

THE LAST WORD

Chartreuse, lime, and maraschino folded into cold gin, brightened with absinthe and crushed mint. 111

ESTATE PINOT NOIR

Silky red Burgundy with dark cherry, soft tannin, and warm earth, served lightly chilled. 135 / 61

CHABLIS PREMIER CRU

Bright mineral Chardonnay with citrus peel and flint, crisp acidity and a long saline finish. 138 / 61

Indulge

SOUR GRAPES

Ruby Roman grapes flash frozen, shattered table-side with velvet crème fraîche and sugared citrus. 104

MOELLE BRÛLÉE

Silken custard enriched with bone marrow and vanilla, finished with a caramelized sugar crust. 111

KURU
FINE DINING
Tribeca, New York, N^o 10013
100 LEONARD ST



Initiate

ORANGE CARPACCIO & CAVIAR 118
Thin blood-orange rounds layered with beluga caviar and young microgreens, finished with aged balsamic and cracked pink pepper.

MARROW CROQUETTES 122
Crisp golden croquettes filled with roasted bone marrow and herbs, served warm with a rich béchamel and a toasted crumb.

FISH TARTARE 131
Hand-cut tropic ahi tuna folded with avocado, lime, and herbs, crowned with a raw quail egg and delicate sheets of gold leaf.

CHARRED CEPHALOPOD 111
Tender octopus charred over an open flame, fully dressed with black garlic oil, preserved lemon, and a young bouquet garni.

The Slab

ANNA CROWLEY 864,908
Prime cut, seared over high flame and finished with molten foie gras and saffron butter, served with charred citrus and smoked salt.

MATTHEW WAVERLY 912,842
Cold preparation dressed with bright lemongrass oil and lime, crowned with a delicately pierced veil of caviar and shaved fennel.

KAYLEIGH PRICE 574,982
Lightly roasted reserve balanced with yuzu oil and fennel pollen, finished with orchid petals and a forensic trace of citrus ash.

AMBER CRYSTAL BISHOP 741,890
Slow caramelized and wrapped around sweetbreads, lacquered in a deep pork blood reduction and finished with cracked spice.

DOMINIC HALE 781,854
Prime selection roasted over open flame and rested in brown butter, finished with charred citrus and cracked spice.

Item 1:
Item 2:

Item 3:
Item 4:

GRAND TOTAL --- PRESENT TO SERVER



Intoxicate

ICEBOX 101
Gin, blood orange, and spiced honey shaken cold, finished with smoked rosemary and a black salt rim.

CORPSE REVIVER No.3 104
Gin, Lillet Blanc, and orange liqueur shaken with lemon, rinsed with absinthe and served ice cold.

THE LAST WORD 111
Chartreuse, lime, and maraschino folded into cold gin, brightened with absinthe and crushed mint.

ESTATE PINOT NOIR 135/81
Silky red Burgundy with dark cherry, soft tannin, and warm earth, served lightly chilled.

CHABLIS PREMIER CRU 138/81
Bright mineral Chardonnay with citrus peel and flint, crisp acidity and a long saline finish.

Indulge

SOUR GRAPES 104
Ruby Roman grapes flash frozen, shattered table-side with velvet crème fraîche and sugared citrus.

MOELLE BRÛLÉE 111
Silken custard enriched with bone marrow and vanilla, finished with a caramelized sugar crust.

KURU
FINE DINING
Tribeca, New York, 89 10012
100 LEONARD ST.

Initiate



ORANGE CARPACCIO & CAVIAR 118

Thin blood-orange rounds layered with beluga caviar and young microgreens, finished with aged balsamic and cracked pink pepper.

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Slow caramelized and wrapped around sweetbreads, lacquered in a deep pork blood reduction and finished with cracked spice.

DOMINIC HALE 781,854

Prime selection roasted over open flame and rested in brown butter, finished with charred citrus and cracked spice.

Item 1: _____ Item 2: _____
Item 3: _____ Item 4: _____

GRAND TOTAL --- PRESENT TO SERVER

DATA CHAPEL

Electronics • Programming • Installation

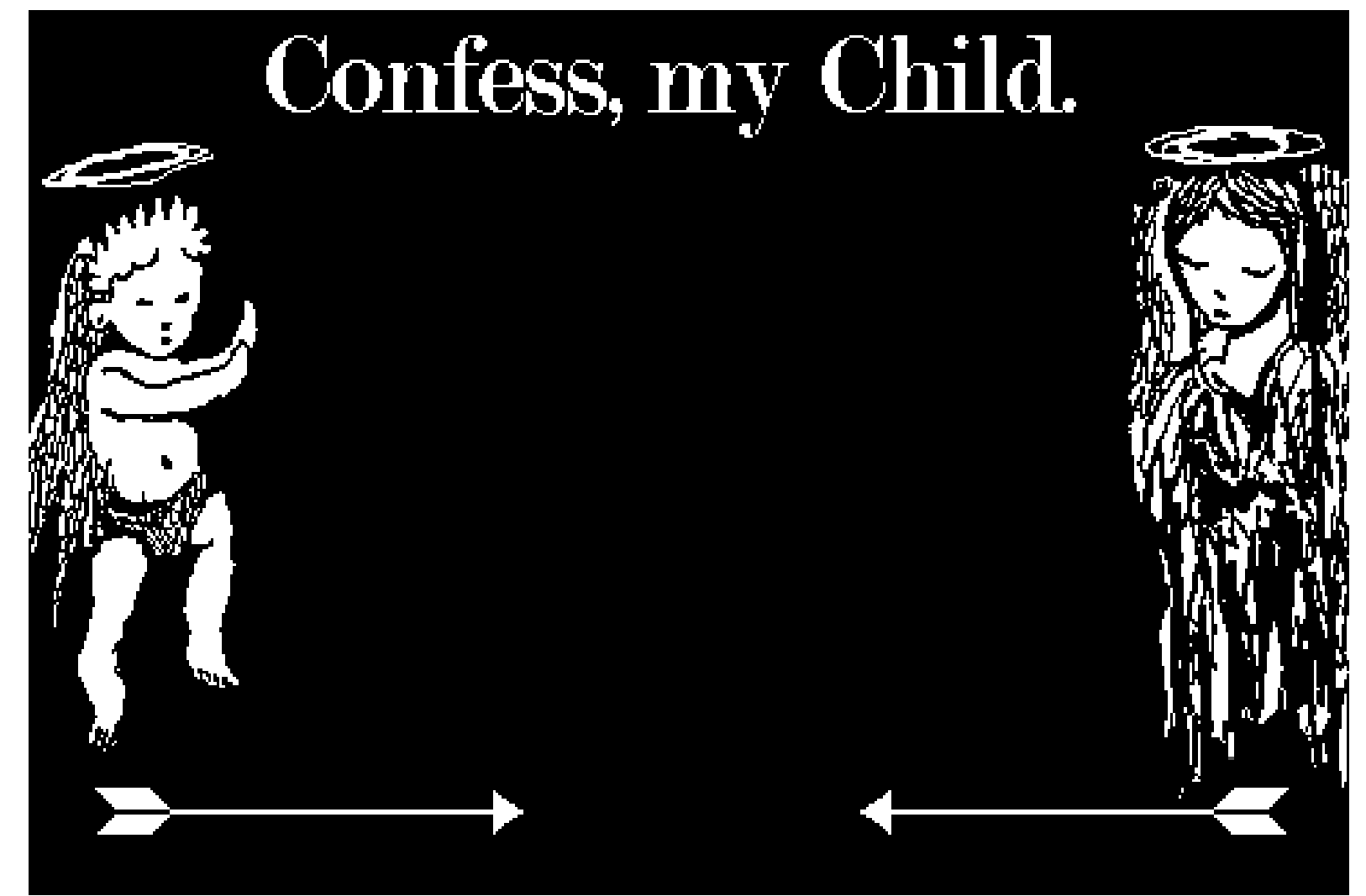
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Data Chapel is an interactive object and program built around a small chapel model that I sculpted from tar, spray foam, and black paint. The software was developed from scratch using Python (specifically Pygame).

Users were instructed to kneel before the drawing touchpad and were prompted to make a confession. After drawing whatever they wanted, they could hit send; where it went was left unclear, though each confession was saved to an SD card and later displayed anonymously.

Confessions and process video available:

https://natebourget.com/data_chapel/




```

import pygame
import sys
import os
import glob
from pygame.locals import *
pygame.init()
screen_width = 480
screen_height = 320
screen = pygame.display.set_mode((screen_width, screen_height))
pygame.display.set_caption("What is Your Confession?")
font = pygame.font.SysFont("Freeseirif", 24)
WHITE = (255, 255, 255)
BLACK = (0, 0, 0)
frame_image = pygame.image.load("frame.png")
frame_image = pygame.transform.scale(frame_image, (screen_width, screen_height)) # Scale to fit the screen
button_rect = pygame.Rect(180, 270, 120, 40) # Position of "SEND" button
draw_area_rect = pygame.Rect(80, 70, 320, 180) # Position of the drawing area
drawing_surface = pygame.Surface((320, 180)) # Match the size of the draw area
drawing_surface.fill(WHITE)
confessions_folder = "confessions"
if not os.path.exists(confessions_folder):
    os.makedirs(confessions_folder)
drawing = False
last_pos = None # Keep track of the last mouse position
animation_frames = [
    pygame.image.load(frame).convert_alpha() for frame in sorted(glob.glob("animations/confession_animation-*.png"))
]
frame_duration = 100 # Duration of each frame in milliseconds
def save_drawing():
    # Save the drawing as an image in the "confessions" folder
    filename = os.path.join(confessions_folder, f"confession_{pygame.time.get_ticks()}.jpg")
    pygame.image.save(drawing_surface, filename)
    print(f"Saved drawing to {filename}")
def play_gif_animation():
    for frame in animation_frames:
        screen.blit(frame, (0, 0)) # Overlay the frame on the entire screen
        pygame.display.update() # Update the display
        pygame.time.delay(frame_duration) # Pause for the duration of each frame
def adjust_mouse_position(mouse_pos):
    return (mouse_pos[0] - draw_area_rect.x, mouse_pos[1] - draw_area_rect.y)
while True:
    screen.fill(WHITE)
    screen.blit(frame_image, (0, 0))
    pygame.draw.rect(screen, WHITE, draw_area_rect) # Ensure the drawing area is white
    screen.blit(drawing_surface, draw_area_rect.topleft) # Draw the current drawing on top of the frame
    pygame.draw.rect(screen, BLACK, button_rect) # Draw the button
    text = font.render("SEND", True, WHITE)
    screen.blit(text, (button_rect.x + 30, button_rect.y + 10)) # Add text to the button
    for event in pygame.event.get():
        if event.type == QUIT:
            pygame.quit()
            sys.exit()
        if event.type == MOUSEBUTTONDOWN:
            if draw_area_rect.collidepoint(event.pos):
                drawing = True
                last_pos = adjust_mouse_position(event.pos) # Adjust for drawing surface coordinates
            elif button_rect.collidepoint(event.pos):
                play_gif_animation() # Play the GIF animation
                save_drawing() # Save the current drawing
                drawing_surface.fill(WHITE) # Reset the drawing surface for the next confession
        elif event.type == MOUSEMOTION and drawing:
            mouse_pos = adjust_mouse_position(event.pos)
            if last_pos and 0 <= mouse_pos[0] < drawing_surface.get_width() and 0 <= mouse_pos[1] < drawing_surface.get_height():
                pygame.draw.line(drawing_surface, BLACK, last_pos, mouse_pos, 2) # Draw line on drawing surface
                last_pos = mouse_pos
        elif event.type == MOUSEBUTTONUP:
            drawing = False
            last_pos = None
    pygame.display.update()

```

→ Confessions ←



CHALLNGR

UI/UX • Motion • Branding

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Challngr is a fitness application developed in Figma that explores motivation through social pressure rather than individual tracking.

Centered around direct challenges between friends and new faces, the project focuses on competition, accountability, and visible progress through a fully prototyped interface system.

Motion graphic available:

<https://natebourget.com/challngr/>

Welcome back,
Katherine Let's crush it!

Active challenges:

Step Challenge **#4**
Rank
📅 4D 11H 👥 4
7,500/10,000 Steps

Heavy Lifting **#1**
Rank
📅 1D 3H 👥 2
300/400 Reps

Past challenges:

Step Challenge **#3**

+ Create Challenge

← Back

7-Day step
challenge **#4**
Your rank

4 Days remain / 4 challengers

 **You** **75%**
7,500/10,000 Steps Complete
⏮ + ⏭ 

Live Leaderboard 

 **Marissa** **#1**
10,000 Steps • 1 Hour ago

First place in Running Challenge 2 20 miles over 3 days



Photo taken 40.01N 30.22W

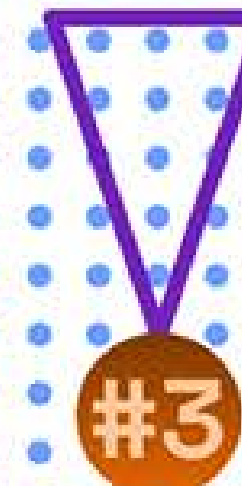
You placed 1st against Mike and Marissa



+ Rematch?

Close award

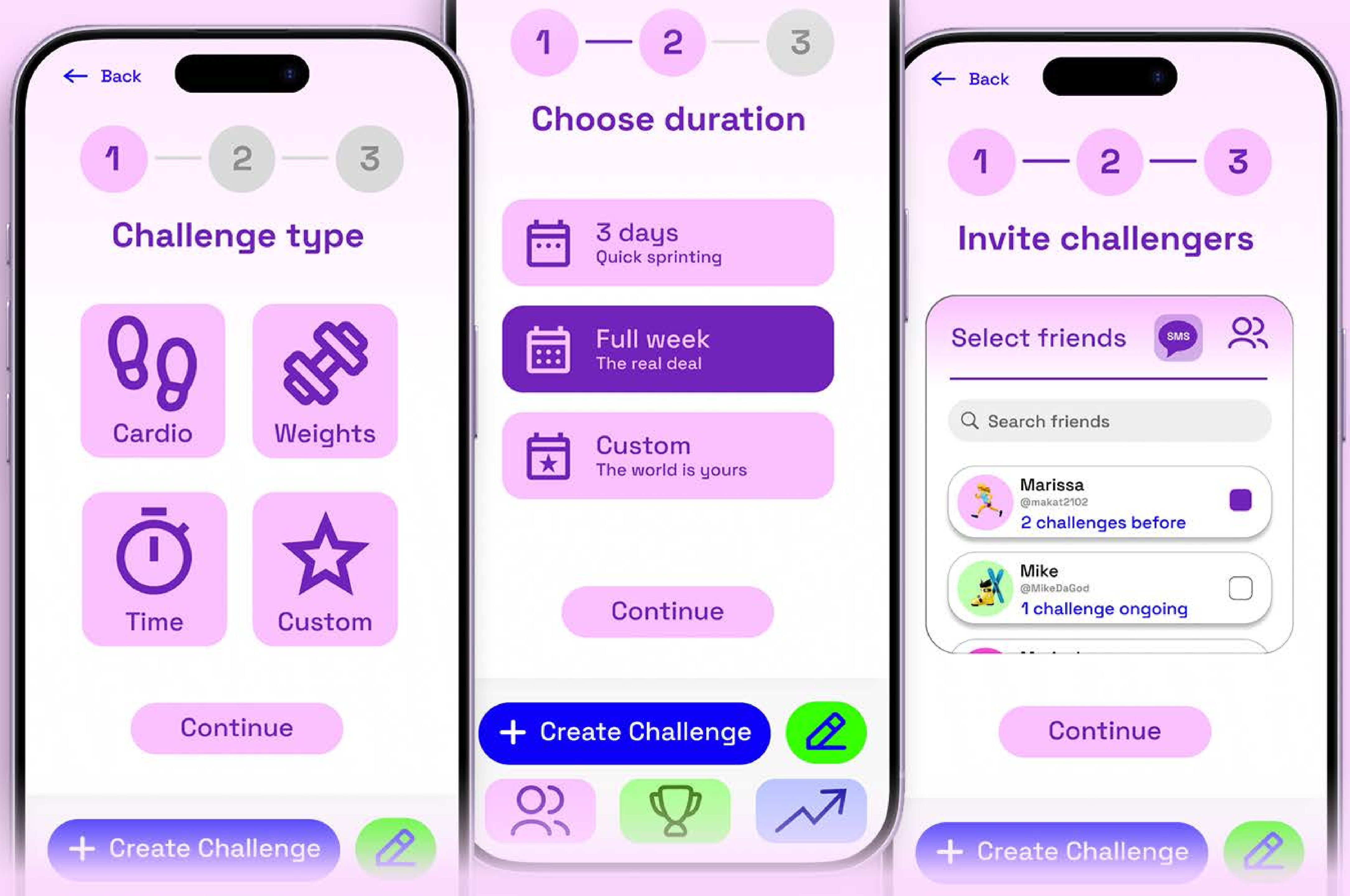
You



Greatest achievements:

+ Create Challenge





AMELIA ZINE

Publication • Craft

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The Amelia Zine is a love letter to Amelia, a typeface developed by Stan Davis in 1967 and later used across retrofuturistic and psychedelic film and book covers.

The publication uses the typeface to imagine guidelines for humans moving to Mars, treating typographic history as a way to build a strange instructional future.

Full zine available:

https://natebourget.com/amelia_zine/



AT
M. H.

Marging

Optimism Guidelines

Version 4.7

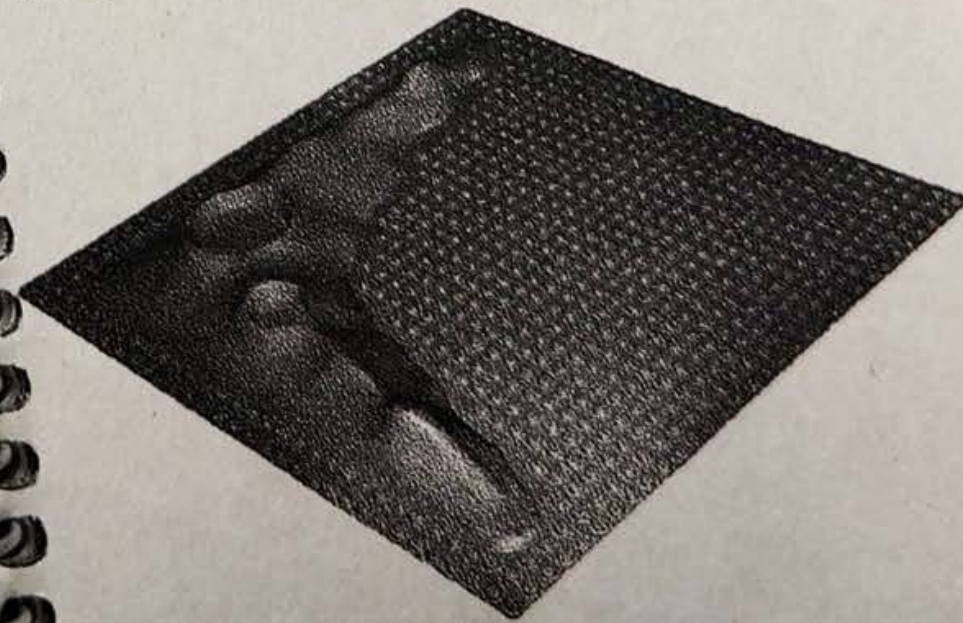
Martian typographic psychologists have identified a measurable link between graphic development and extraspecies harmony. When visual communication is properly aligned, fear becomes productivity, and confusion breeds pride.

Since the early years of the Martian United Military, our colonies have experienced significant emotional turbulence. Many organisms, both terrestrial and Martian, have found it difficult to maintain appropriate posture, morale, and cranial elevation under expanding atmospheric pressures.

Amelia was designed to correct this. As a technologic and psychical typeface, it stabilizes neural frequencies through measured geometry and calm modular rhythm. Field studies suggest that even the simplest glyph can elevate a germ's sense of civic belonging.

Life on Mars is neither tragic nor surreal. Life is a structured, efficient & approved plain of optimism. The Martian United Military remains a symbol of collective care, ensuring that every citizen, plant, and particle contributes to a greater order.

Through design, discipline, and the harmonious union of Earth and Mars, we affirm: there is great strength in clarity, and comfort in command.



Martian

Zappy
flux
drives
whip
quickly
beyond
Jupiter's
moons.

I've been here... here's the first you've seen. But you have no right to call me a murderer. You have a right to kill me. You have a right to do that... but you have no right to judge me. It's impossible for you to describe what is necessary to those who do not know what horror means. I never forget how they... and you must make a friend of horror. Horror and murder must see your friends. If they see that they are destined to be rescued. They are truly human. I remember when I was with Special Forces. Suddenly they had changed. We went into a camp to liberate the children. We left the camp after we had liberated the children the night, and this old man came running after us and he was saying: he couldn't see. We went back there and they had come and looked at every individual man. Then they went to a pile. A pile of little girls. And I remember... I... I... I cried. I went like some personification. I wanted to see my teeth cut. I didn't know what I wanted to do. And I want to remember it.



Merjine

I never want to forget it. I never want to forget. And then I realized... like I was shot... like I was shot with a diamond... a diamond bullet right through my forehead. And I thought: My God... the genius of that. The genius. The will to do that. Perfect, genuine, complete, crystalline, pure. And then I realized they were stronger than we. Because they could stand that there were not monsters. There were men... trained cadres. These men who fought with their hearts, who had families, who had children, who were filled with love... but they had the strength... the strength... to do that. If I had ten divisions of these men our troubles here would be over very quickly. You have to have men who see moral... and at the same time who are able to utilize their primordial instincts to kill without feeling... without passion... without judgement... without judgement. Because it's judgement that defeats us.

CRUSHED!

Branding • Fabrication

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CRUSHED! is a packaging and product design project centered around a pair of 3D printed bicycle grips made from flexible filament.

Extruded skulls sit beneath the fingers and collapse under pressure while riding, creating a physical reminder that your life is literally in your hands. Drawing from grunge graphics and skate culture, the project balances humor, discomfort, and risk through both material and form.

<https://natebourget.com/crushed/>







Thank you for viewing my portfolio. Please find my website at natebourget.com
Please contact me at (617) 750-4639 or email me at ncbourget@gmail.com.

Please view my [qualifications here](#).

The only active typeface used is Atlas Grotesk by Commercial Type

Excited to meet you soon,
-Nate Bourget